

cPoker DRED Closeout

cPoker DRED Development (Cardano After Dark)

Project URL (Catalyst):

<https://github.com/Cardano-After-Dark/hydra-poc/blob/main/docs/blog/close-out.md#cpoker-hydra-case-study-cardano-after-dark>

Project Number: 1300071 - cPoker DRED Development

<https://projectcatalyst.io/funds/13/cardano-open-developers/cpoker-dred-development>

Project Manager: Seomon **Date Project Started:** 15.04.2025 **Date Project**

Completed: 2.12.2025

Executive Summary

The cPoker DRED Development project successfully delivered a complete decentralized real-time communication infrastructure for Cardano dApps. DRED (Decentralized REDIS State Channels) now provides production-ready messaging capabilities with on-chain registration, node-to-node replication, Docker deployment, and comprehensive documentation.

Key Achievement: We eliminated the need for dApp developers to build custom messaging infrastructure by providing ready-to-use, decentralized communication channels with built-in monetization capabilities.

Project Overview

Problem Addressed: Cardano multi-user dApps lacked easy-to-use real-time collaboration capabilities with decentralized infrastructure.

Solution Delivered: DRED enables dApp creators to register their applications in on-chain "DRED Neighborhoods", operate decentralized nodes or connect to existing ones, integrate real-time messaging with a simple client library, and monetize communication channels through wallet integration.

Milestone Achievements

Milestone 1: On-chain Smart Contracts

Delivered: Complete on-chain registration system for node operators and dApp developers

Key Deliverables: Smart contracts in Helios for node and neighborhood registration, protocol settings management, TypeScript integration layer (DredCapo class), token staking requirements for node operators, and configurable incentives and costs for dApp developers.

Impact: Node operators and dApp developers can now register on-chain, creating a trustless discovery mechanism for the DRED network.

Evidence:

- Source code: <https://github.com/Cardano-After-Dark/dred/tree/main/onchain>
 - Deployment: Cardano Preprod Testnet
 - Documentation: <https://cardano-after-dark.github.io/dred/docs/dred-node-registry>
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Milestone 2: Integration & Replication

Delivered: Refined node-to-node communication ensuring network reliability

Key Deliverables: Smart relay protocol preventing message duplication, bookmark-based message streaming for reliable replication, dynamic channel replication across network nodes, connection management with automatic reconnection, and comprehensive test suite for multi-node scenarios.

Impact: DRED network remains functional even during partial outages, with messages reliably delivered across all connected nodes.

Evidence:

- Source code: <https://github.com/Cardano-After-Dark/dred/blob/main/src/server/DredReplicator.ts>
 - Test suite: https://github.com/Cardano-After-Dark/dred/blob/main/src/server/_tests_/replication.test.ts
 - Node Operator Smart Contract Demo: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1GPb1eriLDQ>
 - Message Replication Demo: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=5EreLXTyXNg>
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Milestone 3: Docker-based Deployment Package

Delivered: Production-ready containerization with configuration tools

Key Deliverables: Docker image published to Docker Hub (cardanoafterdark/dred-node:latest), multi-stage build reducing image size by 60%, automated SSL/TLS setup with Let's Encrypt, PM2 process management for reliability, environment-based configuration, and complete deployment guides.

Impact: Third-party node operators can deploy DRED nodes in under 10 minutes using a single Docker command.

Evidence:

- Docker Hub: <https://hub.docker.com/r/cardanoafterdark/dred-node>
 - Deployment guides: <https://github.com/Cardano-After-Dark/dred/tree/main/devops>
 - Docker Setup Guide: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QrrfOW89XQ4>
 - Configuration: <https://github.com/Cardano-After-Dark/dred/blob/main/.env.example>
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Milestone 4: Documentation & Training

Delivered: Comprehensive documentation site, guides, and video tutorials

Key Deliverables: Complete documentation site at cardano-after-dark.github.io/dred, API reference for client library, installation guides for developers and node operators, architecture documentation, node operations guide, blockchain integration guide, video tutorials for key features, and this closeout report.

Impact: Developers can now integrate DRED into their applications and node operators can deploy nodes with comprehensive step-by-step guidance.

Evidence:

- Documentation site: <https://cardano-after-dark.github.io/dred>
 - GitHub README: <https://github.com/Cardano-After-Dark/dred/blob/main/README.md>
 - API Reference: <https://cardano-after-dark.github.io/dred/docs/api-reference>
 - Node Operations: <https://cardano-after-dark.github.io/dred/docs/node-operations>
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Technical Achievements

Architecture:

- Client Layer: Browser and Node.js compatible TypeScript library with automatic reconnection
- Network Layer: HTTP-based protocol (HTTP/2, HTTP/3 compatible) with smart relay
- Storage Layer: Redis for high-performance message storage and pub/sub
- Blockchain Layer: On-chain node registry and neighborhood configuration on Cardano

Code Quality:

- TypeScript 5.8.3 with strict mode
- Comprehensive test suite using Vitest
- Continuous Integration via GitHub Actions
- Type-safe blockchain integration
- Production-grade error handling

Deployment:

- Docker-based deployment with automated SSL/TLS configuration
 - Environment variable configuration
 - Multi-platform support (linux/amd64, linux/arm64)
 - GitHub Pages automated documentation deployment
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Project Metrics

Repository: <https://github.com/Cardano-After-Dark/dred>

- Commits: Over 100 across 4 milestones
- Pull Requests: Over 40 reviewed and merged
- Code Structure: Monorepo with 5 packages (server, client, onchain, docs, sampleApp)

Deliverables:

- Smart Contracts: Helios contracts for on-chain registry (<https://github.com/Cardano-After-Dark/dred/tree/main/onchain>)
- Documentation Site: 15 comprehensive guides (<https://cardano-after-dark.github.io/dred>)
- API Reference: Complete client library documentation (<https://cardano-after-dark.github.io/dred/docs/api-reference>)
- Video Tutorials:
 - Node Operator Smart Contract Demo (<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1GPb1eriLDQ>)
 - Message Replication Demo (<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=5EreLXTyXNg>)
 - Docker Setup Guide (<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QrrfOW89XQ4>)

- Docker Image: Production-ready, optimized image at <https://hub.docker.com/r/cardanoafterdark/dred-node>
- Test Suite: Over 50 integration tests (https://github.com/Cardano-After-Dark/dred/tree/main/src/server/_tests_)

Community Impact:

- Open Source: Full MIT license
 - Reusable: Client library published as npm package
 - Extensible: Clear architecture for community contributions
 - Production Ready: Used in development of cPoker application
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Lessons Learned

What Went Well:

- Modular architecture enabled parallel development
- Docker strategy greatly simplified deployment
- Helios smart contracts worked smoothly on Preprod
- Single-threaded testing prevented Redis state conflicts

Challenges Overcome:

- Base path configuration for Next.js documentation deployment
- Dynamic channel replication required sophisticated bookmark tracking
- Multi-platform builds resolved with TypeScript path aliases
- Redis Streams integration maintained MIT license compatibility

Future Improvements:

- Mainnet deployment of smart contracts
 - Web-based node health monitoring dashboard
 - Automated reward distribution for node operators
 - Extended stress testing for high-volume scenarios
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Sustainability & Impact

Open Source Community: Complete source code available on GitHub with comprehensive contribution guidelines, active Discord and Telegram communities, and clear documentation enabling community growth.

Economic Model: Node operators can earn through staking and service provision, dApp developers can monetize channels, configurable fee structures via smart contracts ensure sustainable decentralized operation.

Ecosystem Benefits:

- Poker dApp: Primary use case enabling real-time multiplayer gameplay
 - DAOs: Voting coordination and proposal discussions
 - Gaming: Multiplayer card games, turn-based strategy
 - DeFi: Price feeds and trade coordination
 - Social Apps: Chat, notifications, activity streams
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Conclusion

The cPoker DRED Development project successfully delivered a production-ready decentralized real-time communication infrastructure for the Cardano ecosystem. All four milestones were completed on schedule:

1. On-chain smart contracts for trustless registration
2. Reliable node-to-node replication
3. One-command Docker deployment
4. Comprehensive documentation and training

DRED now provides Cardano dApp developers with the infrastructure they need to build sophisticated multi-user applications without operating custom messaging servers. The decentralized network of independent node operators ensures high availability while maintaining Cardano's core values of decentralization and community ownership.

The foundation is laid. The network is ready. The ecosystem can now build.

Project Links

Primary Resources:

- Project Proposal: <https://projectcatalyst.io/funds/13/cardano-open-developers/cpoker-dred-development>
- Milestone Tracking: <https://milestones.projectcatalyst.io/projects/1300071>
- GitHub Repository: <https://github.com/Cardano-After-Dark/dred>
- Documentation: <https://cardano-after-dark.github.io/dred>

- Docker Hub: <https://hub.docker.com/r/cardanoafterdark/dred-node>